Diploma in Lightroom

Making Your First Photobook

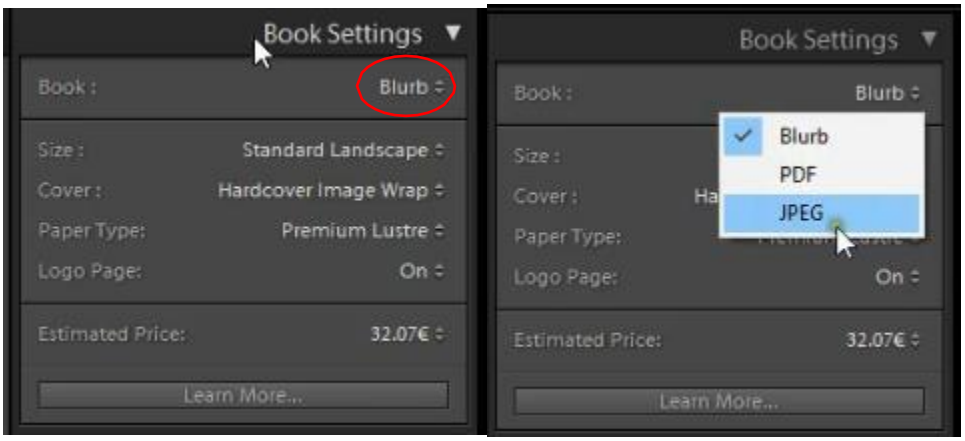
The Book Module

Lightroom has the ability to help you create Photobooks that you can order directly through the program. These are ordered through a printing company called Blurb. You can have a look at their website at www. blurb.com.

We can also simply export the book as a PDF or a Jpg for reference if we wish. We can select these options under the **BOOK SETTINGS** Menu in the Book Module.

Blurb prints at 300 dpi. If an image is less than 300 dpi, a warning icon appears in the upper-right corner of the image cell in the preview area. ❗

Click the warning to see the resolution the image can print. **Blurb** recommends a minimum of 200 dpi for optimum quality.

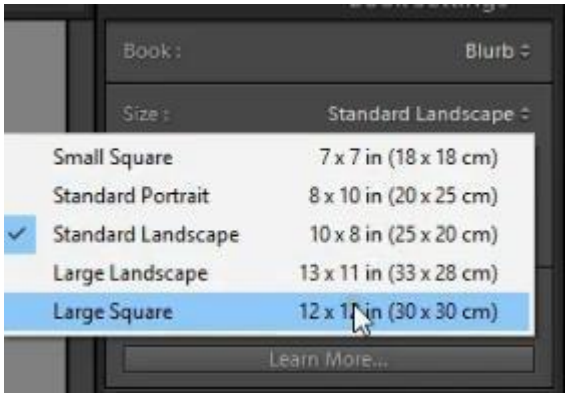


Exploring the Book Module Further the next step to take is to select the photos that we wish to use.

The book module utilises **COLLECTIONS** only, so you will need to move the desired photos into a new collection.

When we have our photos in a Collection, the best way to begin is with the BOOK SETTINGS options and select the shape of the book we wish to print. This is important to do at the start otherwise you could end up having to rearrange the book later if you found that you were not working in the correct format. This is more just an inconvenience rather than a problem but it can mean having to redo a lot of work.

You can select this under SIZE in the BOOK SETTINGS option.

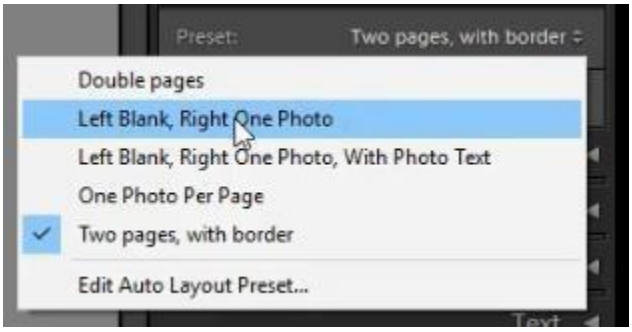


There are many other options to explore here to customise your book the way that you would like too so take time to investigate these.
When we have selected size we can move onto the next option: Auto Layout.

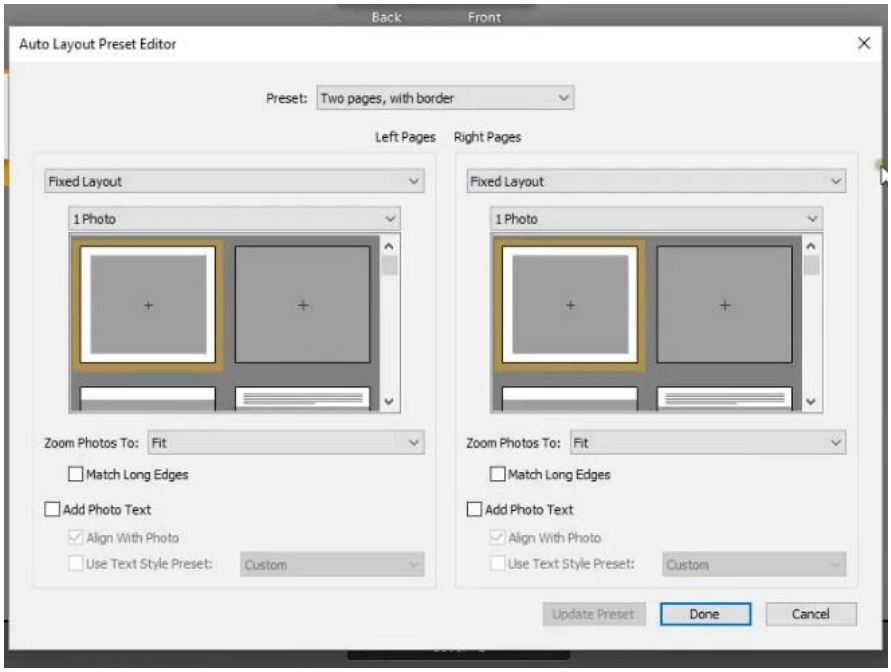
AUTO LAYOUT

This option will automatically layout the book for you and is a good place to start.

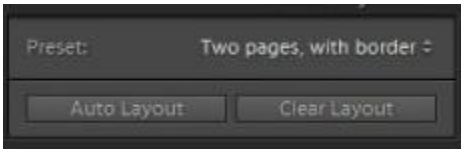
Initially there are some pre-set options available to use but if we already have some idea of how we want our book to look we can create our own pre-set options. It is recommended that when doing this for the first time to use and existing option until you become more comfortable with the module.



To create a pre-set of our own we must select an existing pre-set and from here we can edit the per-set and save it as a separate pre-set, or overwrite an existing pre-set if we wish. When we select the EDIT AUTO LAYOUT PRESET we will presented with this menu:



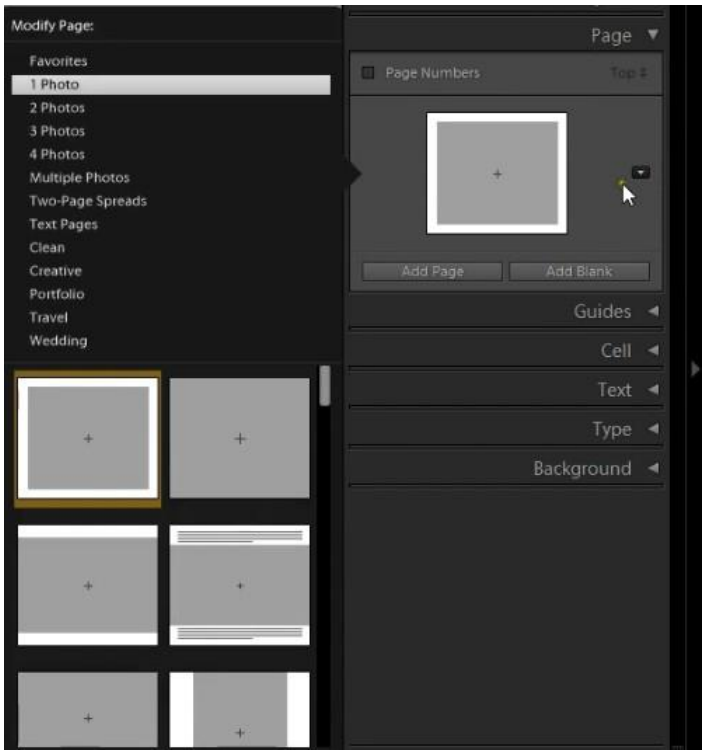
So here we can edit the LEFT and the RIGHT pages. The pages do not have to be the same and it is possible to edit individual pages later, so choose an option that you want the majority of the pages to look like. You can have up to 4 photos per page but there is also a multi photo option if you wish to add many photos to one page.
When you are happy with your layout you can simply click Done and then you can select the Auto Layout and your book will be created. Remember to HIGHLIGHT the photos that you want added to the book in the AUTO creation!



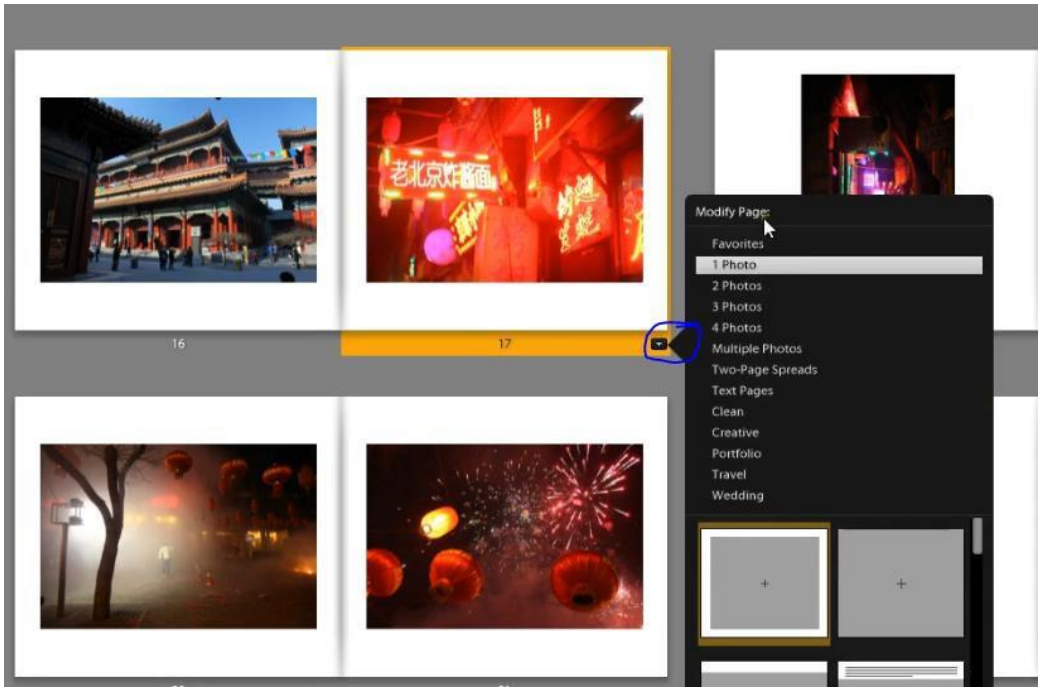
You can clear the layout at any stage with the CLEAR LAYOUTN option.

PAGES

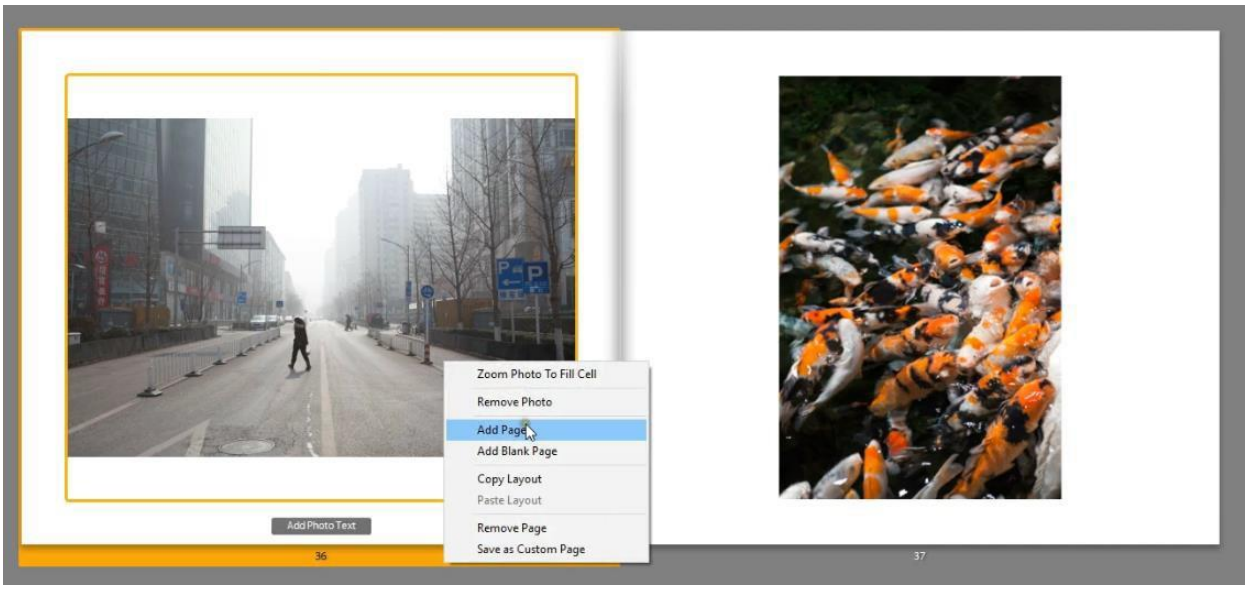
The next step is too look at editing individual pages. We can do this 2 ways. We can use the PAGE option on the Right hand side of the interface:



By clicking this we can edit any page that we have highlighted. We can add more photos to a page, change the layout of a page, and add a new page and so on. Alternatively we can simply click on the page that we want to edit in the book and click the arrow underneath the page to bring up the same options.



You can edit each page how you wish. On each page it is also possible to bring up many more options by Right – Clicking/ CMD + Clicking. This opens a Menu where you can edit the page even more or even Add/remove photos/pages as you can see below. Bear in mind when you delete a photo this does not delete the page so you will have to leave this page black, fill it with another photo or remove the page altogether.



So from here you can really edit your book to your hearts content! Quickly looking at some of the other options.
Guides: These allow you to visualise Gridline and Bleeds and so on for when you are printing. **Guides** do not print. They are used only to help you position photos and text on the page.
Cell

Drag the **Padding** slider to add space, in points, around an image or text in its cell. Using padding is an effective way to customize the appearance of an image in its cell and therefore to customize individual page templates, as well. By default, padding is applied uniformly to all sides. Click the triangle to the right of the **Padding** title to apply different amounts of padding to each side of a cell. You can select multiple cells in the preview area and apply padding to all of them at once.

Text

Allows you to add text fields to individual photos and to entire pages. When you click a photo, a transparent button Add Photo Text is displayed. Clicking the button lets you start adding text immediately. This tip applies to photos and pages.
Photo Text

The caption for the photo can be positioned above, below, or over the selected image cell or cells. You can use the Title or text from the photo's metadata, or enter a custom caption by typing directly into the text field.
Offset

Adjusting the Offset amount moves the text above, below, or on the photo, relative to where you've anchored it.
Above: Positions the caption text between the top edge of the photo and the top edge of the page.

Below: Positions the caption text between the bottom edge of the photo, and the bottom edge of the page.
Over: By default, the position of the caption is on the photo, at the bottom edge. Increasing this value moves the position of the caption towards the top edge of the photo.
Allows you to add text fields to individual photos and to entire pages. When you click a photo, a transparent button **Add Photo Text** is displayed. Clicking the button lets you start adding text immediately. This tip applies to photos and pages.

Photo Text

The caption for the photo can be positioned above, below, or over the selected image cell or cells. You can use the **Title** or text from the photo's metadata, or enter a custom caption by typing directly into the text field.